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Green Republicanism and the Shift to Post-productivism: A Defence of an Unconditional Basic Income

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Abstract

Green republicanism can be described as a subset of republican political theory that aims at promoting human flourishing by ensuring a non-dominating and ecologically sustainable republic. An essential aspect of green republicanism is the promotion of post-productivism while preserving or expanding republican freedom as non-domination. Post-productivism implies the promotion of personal autonomy rather than the pursuit of permanent economic growth and the promotion of labour as an intrinsically positive human activity, which for green republicans will have three positive aspects: reduced ecological impact, more time available for civic participation, and the extension of democratic decision-making and norms to the sphere of production. An important aspect in the definition of a post-productivist society is the way welfare schemes are designed. In this article, I will thus compare the existing welfare regimes with a (green) participation income and with an unconditional basic income, and analyse how they promote green republican goals. I conclude that the current systems are one of the elements of the productivist society and that would not answer the green republican conditions. A green participation income could have a positive ecological impact and contribute to a shift to post-productivism but would face serious challenges from a republican perspective, namely in terms of the non-arbitrariness of its attribution. Finally, I conclude that depending on how it is defined, an unconditional basic income could contribute to post-productivism while being non-arbitrary thus obeying the green republican conditions.

Keywords Republicanism · Welfare · Green republicanism · Basic income · Participation income

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Introduction

Republican political theory has seen renewed interest in the past couple of decades. The focus of this interest has ranged from the review of the concept of liberty as non-domination to the challenges posed to republicanism by an ever more globalised economy and society. At the same time, scientific evidence has shown the damaging and lasting role of human activities with regard to global climate change and other environmental-related problems, leading scientists to dub our current geological epoch 'The Anthropocene'. Republicans have started to look into green political theory but, despite some overlaps, research on the common aspects of the two theories remains limited.

Assuming there are links between republicanism and green political theory, is it possible to talk about green republicanism? In this article, I will argue that there is a case for a green republican theory, consisting of a restrictive view of the overlaps between both republican and green political theories. A key aspect of green republicanism is the promotion of post-productivism, which implies that the core objective of a green republican policy is the promotion of personal autonomy rather than the pursuit of permanent economic growth and the promotion of labour as a human activity with intrinsic and not simply instrumental values. As such, all gains from an increase in productivity should serve to significantly reduce the amount of hours that societies commit to labour, thereby increasing individuals' discretionary time, i.e. 'time the use of which is not dictated by the "necessities of life"'. Such necessities can be divided in three realms: economic, social, and biological (Goodin et al. 2008, p. 34).

It is unlikely that all forms of labour will disappear in the near future. Green republicans, however, would not be anti-labour or anti-economic growth, but would rather be interested in selecting necessary labour activities that would contribute to the promotion of republican freedom while also respecting the ecological limits of the planet. This is to say that labour or employment is not intrinsically wrong—under certain conditions (i.e. with an unconditional basic income (UBI)), labour could constitute a non-dominating, non-discretionary activity. In the end, it would all depend on how it is shaped.

Green republicanism would look to the distribution of both required labour and distribution of discretionary time made available in order to ensure that it would not foster forms of domination (e.g. patriarchal domination), ecological unsustainability, or a social division between those with and without paid jobs. According to green republicans, autonomous and discretionary time in a post-productivist society would arguably need to be spent participating in activities with a low ecological impact and/or activities that serve the republican ideal consisting of civic participation, deliberation, and protection of freedom.

The way in which welfare schemes are designed when drafting policies that promote republican freedom and ecological sustainability must be taken into account, and issues such as the financial sustainability of current welfare schemes and ecological sustainability point towards a paradox. On the one hand, welfare schemes are financed by labour and economic growth, which have a significant

ecological impact. On the other, low economic growth also results in a reduced level of taxable economic activities, thus challenging the maintenance of the current welfare scheme and its services and goods itself (Bailey 2015; Jackson 2017).

Naturally, not all economic growth will have the same ecological and social impact. As Latouche (2009) correctly notes, an increase in public spending, even in areas boasting a clear positive ecological impact (such as public transport), will contribute to economic growth. Moreover, it could be surmised that, in order to move away from the current difficulty presented by ecological unsustainability, governments, nations, and states would implement a thorough and extensive programme of ecological transition. The result would be an increase in economic growth *and* a positive ecological impact. This share of economic growth most likely falls short when faced with the many other activities contributing to orthodox GDP growth. Advocates for degrowth, however, argue that given the dimension of the ecological crisis, structural changes to reduce consumption and growth rather than the promotion of a green form of growth are required (Latouche 2009; Jackson 2017).

If welfare schemes continue to be financed by a combination of labour and economic growth and the decoupling of growth and its ecological impact remains a mirage (Jackson 2017), then such schemes will be actively contributing to the maintenance of a productivist model of economy. The aim of this article is to compare how different models of welfare contribute to or take away from the green republican goal of post-productivism. Existing welfare regimes will be compared with both a green form of participation income (PI) and a UBI. Despite their differences, existing welfare regimes have a set of common characteristics that allow us to assess how they contribute to a post-productivist society. Concerning participation income, a specific green-oriented version will be used for the comparison. Finally, the universal basic income will be discussed, comparing different elements of its composition and how they might impact the promotion of post-productivism.

Green Republicanism

Despite the lack of research on common aspects of both theories, there are several overlaps between green and republican political theories (Barry 2008, 2012, 2017; Barry and Eckersley 2005; Barry and Smith 2008; Cannavò 2012, 2016; Curry 2000; Slaughter 2005; Wall 2014). Examples include non-neutrality regarding the common good, the promotion of civic virtues, deliberative and agonistic approaches to political discussions, and the recognition of the existing interdependencies (both social and nature-oriented).

The acknowledgement of social interdependencies is relevant to republicans as it is through the existence of such interdependencies that domination may occur (Honohan 2002). Green republicanism expands this idea of interdependency to the natural world, making freedom a social *and* ecological matter. This is because the natural environment might limit (or expand) the number of choices available to an individual. As Pettit (2012, p. 36) puts it, one will not be able to raise one's hand 'if

it is so cold that you are frozen stiff'. The recognition of these two interdependencies makes the promotion of post-productivism a key aspect of green republicanism.

Moving away from the dichotomous distinction between positive and negative freedom (Berlin 2002), republicanism conceives freedom in a third way: as non-domination (Lovett 2018; Pettit 1997; Skinner 1998, 2008). This conception is distinct from that of freedom as non-interference in two ways. Firstly, the mere existence of interference may not be considered as freedom-limiting, should such interference be non-arbitrary. Secondly, although interference may not be present, domination could be, should one of the agents have the capacity to interfere in an arbitrary or uncontrolled way. As Lovett simply sums up, 'interference is an action, whereas domination is an ability to act' (Lovett 2016, p. 110).

For republicans, the concept of arbitrariness—and the opposition to it—is extremely relevant, as they define freedom as the absence of arbitrary power. There are two ways in which non-arbitrariness is defined with regard to republican freedom. The first—the procedural way—argues that power will not be arbitrary if constrained by a set of rules and regulations (Lovett 2010); the second—the democratic method—argues that power will be non-arbitrary as long as concerned individuals have the capacity to directly or indirectly resist it and control it (Pettit 1997, 2012). In practical terms, however, both strategies are compatible and there are important synergies between them that need to be explored. In effect, having individuals and groups with the capacity to control rules and regulations is the best way to turn such rules and regulations into a compelling device, and the other way around, having good procedures is a necessary condition to channel and strengthen civic participation.

Philip Pettit, arguably the leading thinker of the republican revival, is well aware of the risks that the 'climate and ecological emergency' (as recently declared by the UK and Irish parliaments for example) poses for republican freedom. Recognising that republicanism might be at odds with more radical approaches to ecologism, he argues that certain approaches of green political theory could find common grounds with his definition of republicanism. He links freedom to the natural world arguing that any damage done to the environment 'means that there is an assault on at least the range of our undominated choice' thus limiting republican freedom (Pettit 1997, p. 137).[1]

As such, any republican theory needs to focus on maintaining a viable and healthy natural environment, including the sustainable use of renewable resources, the responsible use of non-renewable resources such as fossil fuels, and the general 'care of the natural and precarious environment' (Pettit 2014, p. 84). Despite these small references, Pettit never goes into detail on what impact ecological limits could have on republican freedom and, in particular, on a republican government. Here Pettit sadly shares the acknowledgement of the ecological and climate crisis but failure of political theorists to fully examine their implications for human society and established modes of political theorising.

[1] Elsewhere Pettit links the need for a sustainable natural environment in order to protect basic liberties (2012 pp. 111–112; Cf. Pettit 2008).

Pettit's notion that simply caring for the environment is enough should be challenged. As I will discuss below, the planet is currently in a situation of profound and deepening ecological unsustainability and, as such, more than simply 'caring for the environment', there is a need to actively and urgently move away from our current situation of 'actually existing unsustainability' (Barry 2012). Thus, I follow Cannavò (2016, p. 73) when he claims that there are few similarities between republicanism and environmentalism as understood in a reformist and conservationist context, which refuses confronting existing political and economic structure values. However, 'commonalities exist between republicanism and more radical environmental perspectives that articulate a social and political programme beyond reformist or conservationist goals' with a non-neutral approach to the common good, and are focused on moving away from a situation of ecological unsustainability.

Serge Audier (2015) distinguishes 'productivist' from 'ecologist' republicanism, and argues that the next step for republican theory lies in examining ecological challenges. Criticising the fact that republicanism has focused on an unlimited transformation of nature while adopting a productivist model since the nineteenth century, Audier argues in favour of an eco-republicanism which would not refuse science and technology, but rather use both in order to preserve the commons and promote an ecological society.

He continues this reflection in his latest book by analysing how productivism became the main goal for different ideologies and different conceptions of the common good (Audier 2019). In order to move towards post-productivism, Audier proposes a green form of republicanism based on civic participation, deliberation, and the confrontation of different ideas and conceptions of the good. In contrast to other conceptions of republicanism, the uniqueness of this approach hinges on the fact that the unlimited transformation of the natural world in order to promote freedom as non-domination is rejected.

To this end, green republicanism can be defined as a political theory focused on promoting human (and non-human) flourishing through the insurance of a non-dominating and ecologically sustainable republic. Unlike other approaches to republicanism, green republicanism could be defined as post-productivist and non-neutral concerning the common good (Pinto forthcoming).[2] Accepting that humanity is currently undergoing a period of ecological unsustainability (Barry 2012), green republicanism is interested in promoting conceptions of the good that, on the one hand, promote ecological sustainability and, on the other,

[2] Being true that at least some forms of perfectionism are compatible with republican theory, green republicanism, even with a non-neutralist approach to the common good, does not necessarily need to be perfectionist. As Lovett and Whitfield argue, perfectionist principles, on top of encouraging or discouraging certain concepts of the good, need to do so based on the objective value of those conceptions and not simply because of their instrumental use. As they put it, 'to support Calvinism merely because it promotes economic prosperity, say, might not count as perfectionist, while doing so because it genuinely reflects the will of God obviously would' (2016, p. 122). Similarly, defending that the state should promote ecologically sustainable conceptions of the good because they are essential to put us back into a situation of sustainability and reduce ecological-related domination can be seen as an instrumental way to ensure not only human flourishing (and the preservation of the natural world) but also a sane ecosystem and, ultimately, human survival.

promote freedom as non-domination. A means to achieve this lies in promoting post-productivism.

What exactly does the promotion of post-productivism imply? Goodin (2001) claims that the core post-productivist value is autonomy, which he interprets as three policy priorities: income adequacy, temporal adequacy, and minimum conditionality. Income adequacy implies an income amount adequate to an individual's basic needs, temporal adequacy refers to the minimum amount of discretionary time individuals have to spend as they please, and minimum conditionality refers to conditions such as household constitution and (interest in) labour-force participation. In this article, I will compare the different welfare options with the three aforementioned policy priorities in order to assess if the green republican condition of post-productivism promotion is addressed or not.

Offering a similar approach, Fitzpatrick (1998, 1999) presents three key ideas for post-productivist welfare: welfare associationalism, moving from an employment ethic to a work ethic, and self-actualisation. By welfare associationalism, Fitzpatrick examines the need to look beyond the state and the market in terms of social policy-making by promoting 'non-market decentralisation and social participation, where individuals and groups either produce the welfare services which they consume or, where this is unrealistic, have the greatest practicable control over their design and delivery' (Fitzpatrick 1998, p. 18). Moving to a work ethic implies rejecting the idea that paid activity in the formal labour market should be valued over other forms of human activity. Self-actualisation refers to the need for individuals to change their expectations and values in terms of consumption and production patterns, namely by accepting a more frugal way of consumption.

Insisting on a productivist and growth-based economy combined with refusing limits to production and consumption runs the risk of producing serious negative ecological impacts also capable of harming republican freedom. In ecological terms, such limits are required in order to move away from the current situation of unsustainability proven by indicators such as the Ecological Footprint and the Planetary Boundaries. The Ecological Footprint measures to what degree nature is being used against the total amount of nature available, and concludes that, presently, humanity would need the regenerative capacity of 1, 6 Earths (WWF 2016). The Planetary Boundaries is a particularly interesting concept that consists of defining boundaries for nine Earth system processes that should not be exceeded in order for the planet to remain within 'safe operating space'—four of these systems have already passed beyond the limit (Rockström et al. 2009; Steffen et al. 2015).

In one of the best approaches to the concept of limits from a green perspective and proposing an alternative to a growth-based economy, Kate Raworth has used these Planetary Boundaries together with 12 social dimensions in order to develop her 'Doughnut Economics'. Examples of the social dimensions include social equity, political voice, income, and work, as well as access to water, energy, food, education, and healthcare. The 'doughnut' designed by combining both dimensions consists in a 'safe and just space for humanity' between a social foundation—not going below a minimum regarding the social dimensions—and an ecological ceiling—not going beyond the Planetary Boundaries (Raworth 2017).

Furthermore, the productivist model of society has recently led to the concentration of wealth in a reduced number of individuals and enterprises, implying an increased risk of uncontrolled interference (Casassas 2018), as well as an increase in social–economic inequalities that have an impact in terms of ecology, but also in terms of undermining active democratic citizenship (Gourevitch 2015), social solidarity, levels of volunteering, recycling, trust in other people and welfare state institutions, and a whole host of other practices and values (Wilkinson and Pickett 2011; White 2011). Finally, it also leads to a reduction in leisure time used for cultivating and maintaining democratic citizenship and deliberative capacity—essential conditions to promote republican freedom (White 2008).

For these reasons, green republicanism would interest itself in promoting post-productivism by pushing activities from the market *and* the state spheres to the autonomous sphere, which Philippe Van Parijs (2010, p. 2) defines in negative terms as all 'productive activities whose products are neither sold on the market nor commissioned by a public authority'. Examples of activities within the autonomous sphere could include volunteering, time-banks, and local exchange trading systems (LETS). In this sphere of activity, Van Parijs follows, ecological impact is lower than in the others. Moreover, participation in activities within this sphere might also contribute to post-productivism by reducing the social role of paid employment thereby breaking the link between production, consumerism (i.e. socially and ecologically negative forms of consumption), and economic growth.

How, then, could this brief definition of green republicanism be promoted via a welfare regime? The way in which a welfare regime is designed impacts the relationship between welfare, social justice, republican freedom, and ecological sustainability. Social justice and republican freedom may be achieved at the expense of ecological sustainability, and ecological sustainability may, in turn, be achieved without any concern for social justice or republican freedom. Nevertheless, as argued in the previous paragraphs, none of these scenarios would be acceptable under a green republican approach. For the purpose of this analysis, I will argue that a green republican welfare regime must promote post-productivism, while also protecting and promoting republican freedom.

Existing Welfare Regimes

Currently existing welfare regimes are very different, and no single model can be used as a standard. Esping-Andersen (1990) divides the existing models into three relevant categories—liberal, corporatist, and social democratic. Liberal regimes are those in which entitlement rules tend to be stricter and are often associated with stigma. These regimes are means-tested and normally imply modest transfers and modest social insurance. The market has an important role in liberal regimes, as private welfare schemes are either passively or actively supported by the state. In corporatist or conservative regimes, the state has a heavier role and the benefits are normally attributed to workplace contributions—the benefits are proportional to the contributions or previous earnings. Corporatist regimes are normally conservative and based on a (male) breadwinner and thus do not include the family and

non-labour work. Finally, social democratic regimes are more universal in terms of where benefits exist, which, in principle, are given to everyone with a minimum of conditions. Moreover, they tend to be more generous than the liberal regimes concerning distributable benefits.

Of particular interest for this paper is the distinction made by Goodin (2001) on the relationship between the existing welfare regimes and their approach to work. He argues that liberal regimes follow the 'work, not welfare' slogan, corporatist regimes follow the slogan 'welfare through work', whereas social democratic regimes follow the slogan 'welfare and work'. A clarification is required at this point. By 'work' Goodin (2001, pp. 13–14) means mostly employment, as he refers to work in the formal economy, i.e. paid employment in the public or private sector, which is a condition that these regimes have as a way to finance welfare state programmes. Thus, existing welfare regimes are all essentially productivist as they promote labour in the formal economy, i.e. employment as a central aspect of their policies (Goodin 2001; Standing 2009; Van der Veen and Groot 2006).

This focus on labour was also highlighted by Goodin and Rein (2001), who argue that there is a tendency in existing welfare regimes to put participation in the labour market as a condition in order to access welfare. Consequently, all three welfare regimes typically require individuals to engage in formal employment, should they meet certain conditions (e.g. physical, psychological) to do so. I will thus consider that existing welfare regimes include a labour-oriented approach that is interested in the benefits of the labour market and working towards some kind of productive contribution.

As feminist literature has argued, care or domestic work—mostly performed by women—as well as non-productive work such as volunteering, is not considered as work that current welfare regimes are interested in promoting in exchange for welfare benefits (Daly and Lewis 2000; Lewis 2002; Meyer 2002). Thus, existing welfare regimes promote participation in the paid labour market while also actively limiting participation in the autonomous sphere of activities, and, by doing so, simultaneously limit access to welfare benefits.

Focusing on participation in labour markets as a means of accessing welfare benefits implies yet another reason of concern for green republicans, namely the arbitrary manner in which who is fit to work is defined. Goodin (1985) highlights that welfare administrations run the risk of erring on either the side of harshness or generosity. The former could occur when those deserving of welfare benefits would not be receiving them, and the latter when those who do not deserve the benefits would be receiving them. Owing to the fact that making either error is inevitable, a trade-off is required. To reduce a large number of one type of errors may come at the price of increasing the number of cases of the other type.

While Goodin defends welfare administrations' decision to err on the side of generosity during times of economic crisis, he also recognises that the dominant or default political impulses normally err on the side of harshness. Indeed, one of the two types of errors is deemed more politically serious than the other, and so the direction of error is shifted to ensure no citizen benefits from what they should not. Subsequently, this approach hits the most vulnerable and results in more exclusion errors. Ken Loach's fictional character of Daniel Blake, for example, finds himself

in a paradox of being seriously ill while also trapped in a maze of bureaucracy that found him fit to work—as such, he had to actively job seek.

It should be clear at this point that existing welfare regimes would face serious challenges answering the green republican conditions of post-productivism. However, given their differences, it can be argued that social democratic regimes could be in a better position to promote a green dimension of the state—an environmental state—including the promotion of post-productivism (Gough et al. 2008; cf. Gough 2017). The environmental state challenges the productivist framework based on permanent and environmentally blind economic growth. The fact that such regimes are normally more generous and carry fewer conditions makes them the best candidate for obeying green republican conditions.

Gough argues that the paradigm of 'ecological modernisation' could act as a bridge between green and productivist perspectives (Gough 2016). This balance between welfare and ecological sustainability requires a redistribution of income, wealth, work, time, and carbon emissions (Fritz and Koch 2019). Some empirical research, however, does not support the theoretical argument that social democratic regimes are promoting an environmental state (Koch and Fritz 2014).

Furthermore, even if obeying two of the conditions for post-productivism—minimal conditionality and income adequacy—the temporal adequacy would hardly be addressed. This is due to the fact that the focus of current welfare regimes, including social democratic ones, is on employment activities—welfare *and* work as Goodin puts it—which results in a limitation of the time available to participate in activities outside the market or the state (e.g. volunteering or care work). Such activities do not fall under the type of work existing welfare regimes consider valid in order to receive social benefits. Thus, reducing the amount of hours in the labour sphere and moving them to the work sphere while maintaining the three conditions for post-productivism—income adequacy, temporal adequacy, and minimal conditionality—would not be possible unless a substantial reduction in the legal minimum of labour hours took place.

Additionally, even social democratic welfare regimes may be far from minimal conditionality. Goodin and Rein (2001) distinguish existing welfare regimes according to who receives benefits as well as the conditions set to receive them being the principle of conditionality central for the distinction. They define the three ideal–typical regimes as unconditional (social democratic), with means-tested benefits (liberal), and under the condition of workplace contributions (corporatist). They warn, however, that practice departs from principle, and, that in this sense, real-life examples may be quite different from the ideal–typical cases and, in most cases, mix several ideal types. Practically all of existing schemes are means-tested, even if with different degrees of conditionality.

Participation Income

The idea of a PI was first presented by Anthony Atkinson (1996), departing both from a pure workfare social scheme and from an unconditional and UBI. Despite being in favour of unconditionality and refusing means-tested schemes, Atkinson

argued that in order to ensure political support, an unconditional income would not be the best solution, instead preferring an income paid under the fulfilment of at least one of a wide range of conditions.[3] What, then, constitutes criteria for required participation? The first remark refers to the fact that participation 'is not limited to labour market participation', and includes education, training, care work, and other approved forms of voluntary work (Atkinson 1996, pp. 68–69).

Even without other measures in place, a PI could promote post-productivism by motivating people to reduce their amount of hours in the labour market, and instead incite them to dedicate time to activities outside the market and state spheres without losing their benefits. Considering Atkinson's criteria of participation, this would be the case for those wishing to follow educational or training programmes, volunteering activities, as well as those dedicated to home care. A PI, moreover, might serve as a tool to promote the expansion of the concept of social participation and the creation and sustaining of social solidarity, highlighting activities such as caregiving and volunteering (Hiilamo and Komp 2018). It is worth noting that Atkinson only wished to exclude access to income for 'those who devoted their lives to pure leisure' (Atkinson 2015, p. 221).

Atkinson's case for a PI was rather wide and abstract, and the number of detailed defences or criticisms towards a PI remains low—notable exceptions being the works of Pérez-Muñoz (2016, 2018) and De Wispelaere and Stirton (2007). A particularly interesting green defence of a PI—green participation income—was recently made by Sophie Swaton (2018), who makes the case for a PI that would specifically support the ecological transition. This 'Ecological Transition Income' is based on three main characteristics: an income given to those performing one of the accepted activities—paid or unpaid—considered as promoting the ecological transition, a technical support structure, and a democratic form of organisation.

Even if a green PI answers most of the conditions to promote post-productivism (more on this below), numerous reasons exist for why green republicans would be sceptical about such an income, namely its arbitrariness. This is the case regarding the definition of the list of activities that contribute to the ecological transition or the list of unmet social needs (including environmental-related ones). The latter refers to Pérez-Muñoz's (2015, p. 175) defence of PI, which consists of promoting civic services aimed at addressing unmet social needs including, among others, 'neighbourhood clean-ups and environmental protection projects'.

Who has the power to define and maintain such a list, as well as who has the capacity and power to influence what appears on the list or how frequently it is updated are questions that must be answered. In Sophie Swaton's proposal, any individual could propose an activity to be added to the list of activities contributing to the ecological transition; however, this begs the question who or what institution or agency or process would be responsible for accepting them and on what conditions?

[3] It should be noted that Atkinson later claimed reciprocity originating from participation criteria is 'both *intrinsically* justified and more likely to garner political support' (Atkinson 2015, p. 221, emphasis added).

What criteria would be used to consider proposals 'green enough' to contribute to an ecological transition?

As such, there is the risk that certain activities required to promote ecological transitions and address unmet social and environmental needs have not yet been identified, and consequently, not met. The main problem for green republicans is that these needs are systematically, rather than accidentally, unmet. Certain activities that could contribute to the ecological transition might never be published, whereas activities that do not contribute to an ecological transition could be published—a situation green republicans would rather avoid.

The definition and calculation of the total amount of participation can also lend itself to arbitrariness. As Torry questions, 'how much self-employment would count? How much voluntary activity? Caring for whom? How much disability would exempt someone from satisfying a participation condition?' (Torry 2016, p. 125). All these questions highlight the arbitrariness of a participation income, namely the exact definition of what activities within the non-labour sphere would count as participation (arguably, not all would fall under that list), but also regarding what amount of participation would be considered a minimum in order to receive a PI.

Finally, even if assuming that a list of activities which would be accepted in order to receive a green PI could be defined *and* include all or most of non-labour activities, the issue of arbitrariness arises once again under the guide of control of such activities. This issue is particularly relevant for those performing a reduced number of hours in multiple activities. Consider an unemployed citizen choosing to dedicate time to following her dream of becoming a painter, gardening in order to cultivate food, working in a community garden, buying certain food items from a cooperative of local farmers, and collecting a full bag of litter every day. Assuming that even some of these activities could be seen as contributing to the ecological transition, controlling how such activities are performed (and at least in the amount of time defined as minimum to access the green PI) is a task prone to arbitrariness.

And what of the promotion of post-productivism? Given that Swaton's proposal remains rather abstract regarding certain significant elements, such as the amount of the PI and the amount of participation required as a minimum in order to benefit from it, this green PI might answer differently to the green republican conditions set for this article. I will thus make some assumptions that might make a green PI likely to answer the conditions set.

The first criterion for a post-productivist welfare, namely income adequacy, is dependent on the amount of green PI. Swaton's proposal is not clear regarding her ecological transition income; however, one is to assume its level resembles that of subsistence, thus obeying the income adequacy clause. Moreover, a green PI could be accumulated with other sources of income, namely from formal employment. This is an important difference from existing welfare schemes which might contribute to post-productivism by allowing individuals to shift hours currently spent in employment to other non-labour or reproductive activities outside the market or state spheres.

The second criterion, temporal adequacy, is dependent on the time individuals need to spend in activities identified as contributing to the ecological transition

thereby giving them access to the green PI. If too high a number is required, the amount of discretionary time will be low, thus failing the time adequacy clause. Even assuming a scenario where the green PI is generous, the availability of temporal adequacy is nevertheless dependent on the minimum number of hours—be it in the labour or in the work sphere—required to benefit from the PI. Let us assume a scenario where a reduced number of hours is accepted, thus answering the temporal adequacy clause.

The minimum conditionality clause is another point of difficulty for a green PI. A PI has, by definition, a condition of participation. Unlike participation required in existing welfare regimes, the kind of participation required by a green PI includes non-labour activities such as volunteering, education, or care work. As such, even if there are conditions in accessing a PI, they are less demanding than in existing welfare schemes. For green republicans, however, independently of how conditionality is shaped, it will always open up the doors to arbitrariness. This is so because someone will always end up being in the position to accept and reject people/applications. Even if conditions are less harsh, they are still conditions, and therefore they bring all freedom-limiting effects of conditionality.

Furthermore, as Zelleke (2018) notes, the fact that a PI is defended from a normative perspective implies a work/leisure dichotomy—the former obeying the reciprocity condition and the latter failing at it. She continues by stating that a third category of human activity, care work, exists. Although Atkinson includes care work in his criteria of participation, the fact that he starts from a point which minimises care work carries two main problems. Firstly, prioritisation would be given to the identification of potential free-riders rather than ensuring that income would go to those in need of support. Secondly, 'selective reciprocity' of a PI regarding care work obliges 'caregivers to document the care they provide (…) but not for recipients of care to document what they provide in exchange for the care they require' (Zelleke 2018, p. 277). This selective reciprocity would favour the rich or powerful enough to decide reducing their working hours without the need of a PI, thus not having to continually prove that they are participating.

Unconditional Basic Income

Unlike the idea of a PI, the idea of an unconditional basic income has not only received wide attention in the past years, but has also featured in some of the most important global forums of discussion (De Wispelaere and Haagh 2019). A UBI implies an income paid in cash, on an individual basis, unconditionally (without means-test or work requirement) and universally to all citizens or long-term residents of a political territorial area (Van Parijs and Vanderborght 2017). The amount of such an income, however, is disputed. While some argue that a UBI needs to be set at a level of sufficiency, others defend a below-sufficiency (i.e. partial) amount. For green republicans, as shall be seen below, this is an important discussion.

Despite appearing a promising tool for green republicans, a green participation income would face challenges promoting post-productivism while being non-arbitrary. Could an unconditional basic income perform better? Several papers and books have looked to both the republican and green cases for a UBI.[4] The following section will aim to examine a specifically green republican approach, namely by discussing if a UBI can (and under which conditions) be a non-arbitrary tool for post-productivism.

It is not surprising that both advocates of a green UBI and republican theorists have looked into the connections of both concepts. Casassas and Birnbaum (2008) argue that a UBI can promote republicanism by ensuring economic conditions for individuals to live free from domination and ensure participation in a genuine democratic self-government, making them better capable of exercising republican civic virtues thanks to the fact of having such economic/income security. They agree with ecologists criticising those who focus exclusively on paid work as an essential tool for citizenship. For them, the basis of citizenship, community and participation cannot exclusively be defined by paid work because, by doing so, those unable to do such work are devalued. Thus, a UBI would be a tool for post-productivism, enabling a range of diverse contributions and dispositions essential to a healthy democratic republic *and* moving away from a situation of ecological unsustainability.

Would this, however, really be the case independently of the way in which the UBI is designed? A big challenge for UBI lies in that extra income unconditionally given to all citizens might not promote the reduction in participation in the labour sphere and the increase in participation in the autonomous sphere. On the other hand, it could serve as a way of promoting further unsustainable and inequality producing consumerism. This is indeed one of the expected outcomes of several defences of a UBI, including certain green perspectives (Howard et al. 2019). In summary, such proposals argue that a UBI could foster individuals' purchasing power, thus promoting consumerism, presenting a UBI as a way of promoting (green) growth. As we have seen, the current scenario of ecological unsustainability is one of the reasons why green republicans would be interested in reducing total consumption; therefore, they could hardly support a UBI proposal aimed at fostering it.

It is thus clear that a UBI will not have an automatic effect on the promotion of the autonomous sphere or a reduction in overall consumption. A possible response is that a UBI could support breaking the link between income and formally paid employment. An income unconditionally given to everyone would contribute to this effort by breaking the 'unholy link' between the need for employment (and the respective economic growth and environmental impact) and economic security (Andersson 2010). It would perform better than a PI because such economic security would automatically be available to everyone, avoiding the kind of problems around arbitrariness discussed in the previous section.

In one sense, a UBI would represent a more concrete and stable incitement for individuals to consider reducing certain hours of their labour-related activities, as it

[4] Among many others, see the special editions of the Basic Income Studies on republicanism (Volume 2, Issue 2, 2007) and on sustainability and post-productivism (Volume 4, Issue 2, 2009).

would remove 'some of the "productivist" pressures and anxieties and thus pave the political road towards targeted and selective environmental policies, some of which are bound to entail the termination of certain lines of production and production processes' (Offe 1992, p. 76). Green republicans would, however, need to ensure that the reduction in the amount of time spent in the labour sphere would not result in an increase in discrimination at the workplace regarding promotions or security of employment (Marston 2016), nor other forms of discrimination, such as gender-biased jobs (Cf. Pateman 2004; Robeyns 2001). To be clear, there is no certainty that a UBI would lead automatically to activities supporting the ecological transition, which makes the political/cultural collective action for post-productivist activities necessary (Howard et al. 2019). The point here is that a UBI can free time and therefore indirectly favour the social extension of these activities.

A key question arises at this point: would any UBI have the possibility to contribute to breaking the link between productive work and income? That is hardly the case. There are different reasons for which green republicans would favour a generous and close to sufficiency-level UBI. Firstly, if a UBI is set to a low amount, it might improve the individual's life but would hardly have an effect on the promotion of republican freedom (Casassas and De Wispelaere 2016, p. 288). This is due to the fact that the economic floor required by republicans ensures that it makes a real impact in the individual's bargaining power and their possibility to satisfy basic needs.

Secondly, from an ecological perspective, a generous UBI is better placed to promote post-productivism, and the shift to a post-productivist model of economy as individuals would have less pressure to participate in the labour market (Cf. Gorz 1999; Mylondo 2010; Pateman 2004; Perkiö 2015). In order for a positive ecological impact and the avoidance of an increase in production and consumption to follow this shift towards post-productivism, other measures such as a maximum income or stronger redistribution policies aimed at increasing equality would be required (Casassas 2018; Casassas and De Wispelaere 2016; Fitzpatrick 2010; Howard et al. 2019; Robeyns 2017).

A UBI can yield positive ecological results in two ways: first, as a result of what individuals decide to do after receiving it independently of the way it is funded, and, secondly, based on the way it is financed (Pinto 2018). Thus, even if a generous UBI could help achieve the former, the positive ecological impact would still be dependent on sources of funding. As such, green republicans would prioritise forms of financing aiming to reduce the ecological impact of human activities *and* reduce the risk of domination. Examples include taxation of wealth, inheritances and Pigouvian taxes, i.e. taxes in products and activities that have negative ecological impact, aiming at internalising the cost of impact.

Finally, and particularly relevant for this paper, a generous UBI is best placed to ensure that individuals feel safe enough to reduce their participation in the labour market and engage in activities within the autonomous sphere. For green republicans, a UBI at subsistence level allowing individuals to live without performing any kind of job is not the only option. A generous UBI, even if below subsistence level, might allow the reduction in hours spent in the labour sphere, namely in polluting activities, by devoting those hours to other activities with a smaller ecological

impact. Furthermore, a generous UBI could also serve as a way of promoting jobs in the social economy, which would normally be less remunerated but have a smaller ecological impact as they are less subject to the obligation of economic growth (Barry and Smith 2005). Freed from the need to seek and perform paid productive activity in order to access an income that ensures sufficiency, individuals receiving a UBI would be less pressured to perform unwanted yet obligated tasks.

Basic income could motivate people to participate in autonomous sphere activities (e.g. time-banks) which could, in turn, contribute to the effort of completing state welfarism through co-production at a more local level (Bailey 2015). As such, individuals could make use of their autonomous time by using their knowledge, skills, and leisure time in areas such as care work, thereby complementing state welfare (or filling the gap, should it not be covered) without falling back on market solutions. This is part of the welfare associationalism proposed by Fitzpatrick and referred in the 'Green Republicanism' section.

Thus, a UBI would appear better prepared than the two other options regarding the promotion of post-productivist goals of temporal and income adequacy as well as minimal conditionality. Moreover, a UBI would avoid—or at least reduce—the risks of arbitrariness in its attribution, thus being preferable from a green republican perspective. Another reason for which green republicans could favour a UBI lies in the fact that, unlike a PI, it avoids selective reciprocity, which favours those rich enough or powerful enough to decide to reduce their working hours without the need of a PI or UBI and, thus, without having to constantly prove that they are practising some sort of participation. Consequently, a UBI promotes the increase in social value of activities outside the labour market.

Conclusion

Green republicanism aims at promoting republican freedom while remaining within the ecological limits of the planet and ensuring the resources for human flourishing for all, and ensure that 'good lives do not have to cost the earth'. Given that an employment-obsessed and growth-dependent economy has resulted in 'actually existing unsustainability', green republicans are interested in the promotion of post-productivism while preserving freedom as non-domination. Post-productivism implies that the focus of a state's policies is not on the promotion of employment as a central aspect of citizenship nor that economic growth is a goal unto itself. The focus lies rather in the promotion of personal autonomy, which involves three main characteristics: income adequacy, temporal adequacy, and minimum conditionality.

An important element in the promotion of post-productivism is the way in which welfare schemes are designed. In this article, I have compared existing schemes with a green-oriented PI and a UBI. I conclude that current systems are an element of a productivist society incapable of answering green republican conditions. A green PI could have a positive ecological impact and contribute towards a shift to post-productivism, but would face serious challenges from a republican perspective, namely in terms of the non-arbitrariness of its attribution. Finally, I conclude that,

depending on how it is designed, a UBI could contribute to post-productivism while being non-arbitrary and thus obeying the green republican conditions.

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